Understanding Canadian law

Grade 11 · Worksheet C

Name: _____

Date: _____

Part 1 — Circle the right answer

1. What does the rule of law mean?
   a) The police decide what the law is
   b) Only judges have to obey laws
   c) The prime minister is above the law
   d) Everyone, including the government, must follow the law

2. What is the fundamental principle of sentencing in the Criminal Code?
   a) Proportionality: the sentence fits the seriousness of the offence and the offender's responsibility
   b) The same sentence for every offence
   c) The victim chooses the sentence
   d) The harshest sentence possible every time

3. Which level of government makes criminal law in Canada?
   a) School boards
   b) Parliament (federal)
   c) Municipalities
   d) The provinces

4. The famous negligence case Donoghue v. Stevenson (1932) was about…
   a) the sale of a house
   b) a snail said to be in a bottle of ginger beer
   c) a hockey injury
   d) a car crash in Toronto

5. In which year did the equality rights in section 15 of the Charter come into force?
   a) 1867
   b) 1960
   c) 1985
   d) 1982

6. A 16-year-old in Ontario signs a contract to buy a gaming console. In general…
   a) the store can have the minor arrested
   b) the contract cannot be enforced against the minor
   c) the minor must pay whatever the contract says
   d) the contract becomes a criminal matter

Part 2 — Number these events in order, 1 for the earliest

- [ ] The Civil Code of Québec comes into force
- [ ] The Canadian Bill of Rights is passed
- [ ] R. v. Morgentaler strikes down the Criminal Code's abortion provisions
- [ ] The Constitution Act, 1867 divides powers between Parliament and the provinces
- [ ] Parliament passes the first Criminal Code

Part 3 — Answer in two or three sentences

A government passes a law that limits a Charter right. Describe the steps a court uses to decide whether the limit is justified under section 1.

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